



LYNTON EVENTS

We make it Happen

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT SERIES

USHERS TRAINING & BRIEFING

A practical handbook for confident,
professional event teams.

SATURDAY, 26 SEPTEMBER 2026

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LYNTON EVENTS | WE MAKE IT HAPPEN

01 — START HERE

The experience begins with you.

An usher is often the first human connection a guest has with an event. Your presence, preparation and attitude set the tone.

“Your attitude is part of the event experience.”

01

Be welcoming

A warm smile, eye contact and a clear greeting tell every guest: you belong here.

02

Be alert

Notice confusion, congestion and special needs early—then act or report.

03

Be professional

Stay calm, respectful, discreet and fully present throughout your assignment.

BY THE END OF THIS TRAINING

You will know how to welcome and guide guests, manage seating and movement, support VIP protocol, communicate clearly, work as one team and respond calmly when plans change.

02 — IDENTITY

Who is an usher?

The first point of contact between the event and the guest.

01 WELCOMING

02 ALERT

03 PROFESSIONAL

04 HELPFUL

05 RESPECTFUL

06 APPROACHABLE

“See the person. Read the moment. Make the way clear.”

03 — THE ASSIGNMENT

Before. During. After.

Professional service starts long before the first guest arrives and continues until the final debrief.

BEFORE**Prepare**

- Arrive early
- Attend briefing
- Learn the venue layout
- Locate entrances, exits and washrooms
- Check seating and signage
- Identify VIP areas
- Confirm emergency procedures

DURING**Serve**

- Welcome every guest
- Give clear directions
- Assist with seating
- Manage movement
- Support guests who need help
- Report issues early
- Coordinate with security

AFTER**Close well**

- Guide orderly exits
- Assist with movement
- Report incidents
- Hand in lost property
- Check your station
- Join the final team debrief

04 — FIRST IMPRESSIONS

The 5-second welcome.

Every guest should feel acknowledged quickly, naturally and respectfully.

01**SMILE**

Be warm and genuine.

02**MAKE EYE CONTACT**

Show that you are present.

03**GREET**

Use a courteous welcome.

04**OFFER HELP**

Ask what the guest needs.

“Karibu. May I assist you with finding your seat?”

05 — LANGUAGE

Clear. Calm. Courteous.

Words build confidence. Choose language that reassures the guest and protects the event.

USE

- Please
- Thank you
- Welcome
- Excuse me
- Kindly
- May I assist you?

AVOID

- I don't know.
- That's not my job.
- Arguing or shouting
- Slang with guests
- Negative comments about organisers

SAY THIS INSTEAD

"Let me confirm that information for you."

"Let me connect you with the person who can assist you."

06 — YOUR IMAGE

Dress the part.

You are part of the event's image. Smart, clean and coordinated presentation inspires trust.



Clean, neat outfit



Appropriate, comfortable shoes



Well-groomed hair



Minimal accessories



Fresh breath and good hygiene



Visible name tag or ID



Phone kept away while on duty

07 — MOVEMENT

Seat with confidence.

Know the map before guests need it. Consistent directions prevent confusion and congestion.

KNOW THE AREAS

- General seating
- Reserved / VIP seating
- Family or special seating
- Staff zones
- Restricted areas
- Emergency exits

GUIDE THE GUEST

- Face the direction of travel
- Use a calm, clear instruction
- Walk with the guest when possible
- Keep pathways open
- Never guess—confirm first
- Avoid conflicting directions

“Kindly proceed this way. I will show you your seating area.”

08 — DISCRETION

VIP & protocol.

Excellent protocol feels effortless: respectful, calm, coordinated and never attention-seeking.

01

KNOW

Confirm designated VIP areas and the approved arrival route.

02

COORDINATE

Work with the protocol officer; communicate changes immediately.

03

PROTECT

Avoid crowding, unnecessary announcements or public discussion.

04

ESCALATE

Pass special requests to the authorised team member.

IMPORTANT

Never change protocol arrangements independently. Act only when authorised.

09 — DE-ESCALATION

Keep it CALM.

The goal is not to win an argument. The goal is to protect dignity, safety and the guest experience.

C**CONTROL**

your emotions

A**ACKNOWLEDGE**

the concern

L**LISTEN**

carefully

M**MOVE**

the issue to the right person

"I understand your concern. Let me get the event coordinator to assist you."

10 — CROWD MANAGEMENT

Guide. Clear. Alert.

Ushers support safe movement. Ushers are not security officers.

DO**Your role**

- Guide guest movement
- Prevent unnecessary congestion
- Keep entrances and pathways clear
- Direct guests consistently
- Alert security when necessary

DON'T**Know the boundary**

- Do not physically confront a guest
- Do not attempt security interventions
- Do not leave your station silently
- Do not spread unconfirmed information

WHEN RISK ESCALATES

Stay at a safe distance. Notify security immediately. Give the exact location and a brief description. Continue guiding other guests only when safe to do so.

11 — BE READY

Know before you need to know.

Preparation keeps instructions calm, accurate and useful when every second matters.

Emergency exits

Assembly point

First-aid location

Security personnel

Event coordinator

Communication channel

IN AN EMERGENCY

STAY CALM

!

ALERT THE TEAM

!

GUIDE GUESTS

!

AVOID PANIC

!

FOLLOW THE PLAN

12 — ONE TEAM

Say less. Mean more.

Radio and phone communication should be short, clear, professional and relevant.

**AVOID**

"There is something happening over there, maybe you should come."

USE

"Coordinator, assistance required at the main entrance."

13 — BOUNDARIES

Protect the standard.

The actions you avoid are as important as the actions you take.

- | | |
|---|------------------------------------|
| ✗ Leave your position without informing the team leader | ✗ Use your phone unnecessarily |
| ✗ Eat while attending to guests | ✗ Sit in guest areas while on duty |
| ✗ Take photos with guests without permission | ✗ Argue with guests |
| ✗ Share confidential event information | ✗ Drink alcohol while on duty |
| ✗ Give unauthorised instructions | ✗ Abandon your station |

14 — LEARN BY DOING

Five practical drills.

Keep simulations short. Rotate roles. Debrief what worked and what should change.

01 THE WELCOME

Greeting, eye contact, directions, assistance

02 DIFFICULT GUEST

Listen, stay calm, resolve or escalate

03 VIP ARRIVAL

Coordinate discreetly with protocol

04 LOST GUEST

Clarify the need and guide professionally

05 ENTRY CONGESTION

Communicate, open flow and escalate risk

15 — FINAL BRIEFING

Know the six answers.

No usher should take a station without clarity on these essentials.

WHO

is the team leader?

WHERE

are you stationed?

WHAT

is your responsibility?

WHEN

do you report?

WHO

do you report to?

HOW

will the team communicate?

THE GOLDEN RULE

SEE IT !' ASSESS IT !' ASSIST OR REPORT IT

16 — OUR PROMISE

The usher's pledge.

"I will represent the event with professionalism, respect and integrity.

I will welcome guests warmly, communicate clearly, work as part of a team, follow instructions and remain calm under pressure.

I understand that every guest interaction contributes to the overall event experience."

NAME / SIGNATURE

DATE



Make your next event extraordinary.

One team. One standard. One unforgettable guest experience.

OUR SERVICES

EVENTS MC • EVENT PLANNING & COORDINATION
TEAM BUILDING • CORPORATE EVENTS • SPECIAL EVENTS
LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT • CUSTOM WORKSHOPS

LET'S MAKE IT HAPPEN

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